WHITE SOURDOUGH BREAD



YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
1 loaf	**30 min**	**4-18 h bulk, then 5-6 h in the pan**	**about 24 h**

OVEN	UNIT WEIGHT	ENERGY COST	PRICE
425F for 20 min, then 375F for 20-25 min	**600 g**	**$2.58 (45 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**	**$8**

DETAILS

- Tags: vegan

INGREDIENTS

100 g	Active starter
10 g	Kosher salt
430 g	Water, room temperature
512 g	Bread flour
a few tbsp	Olive oil
for greasing the pan	Butter

METHOD

1. Stir the starter, salt and water together. It does not need to be uniform.
2. Add the flour and mix until no dry flour remains. A straight-sided container makes the rise easy to judge.
3. After 30 minutes, reach in and pull the dough up into the centre, turning the bowl a quarter turn each time, 8 to 10 pulls. Repeat every 30 minutes for the first two hours if you are around. One fold is still worth doing.
4. Coat with a splash of olive oil, cover, and bulk ferment at room temperature, around 70F, for 4 to 18 hours. Go by volume, not the clock: stop at 50% growth. Hot or humid rooms can get there in 4 to 6 hours.
5. Grease a 9x5 or 10x5 inch loaf pan with butter.
6. Oil the dough and your hands. Release it from the container without deflating it, turn out, fold envelope-style, then shape to a rough rectangle.
7. Set it seam-side down in the pan and stretch gently to an oblong.
8. Second rise 5 to 6 hours, until the dough reaches the rim. Do not rush this one, the rim is what gives the loaf its height.
9. Bake at 425F for 20 minutes, drop to 375F, then 20 to 25 minutes more until golden all over. Internal temperature 206 to 210F.
10. Turn out onto a rack and cool at least 30 minutes before slicing.

NOTES

430 g water against 512 g flour is 84% hydration, which is high for a sandwich loaf. The recipe itself says you can use less, so hold some back if the dough is unmanageable.
Judge the bulk on volume rather than time. 50% growth, not doubled.
Do not use the oven with the light on to bulk ferment, it runs too warm.
After shaping you can oil the surface, cover, and retard the pan in the fridge overnight, then finish the next day. That is the lever for fitting it around a schedule.
Vegan as written. The butter is only for greasing the pan, so oil or spray keeps it vegan.

PRESERVING

Freeze what you will not eat within a couple of days. Sliced before freezing means you toast straight from frozen instead of thawing the whole loaf.
Cool completely before wrapping, or condensation makes the crust soggy.
Slice, then freeze in a bag with the air pressed out.
Dough can be retarded in the fridge overnight after shaping, but freeze the baked loaf rather than the shaped dough.

LEARNINGS

- The one I actually use for white bread, so it stands as the house formula. No scorecard numbers recorded yet.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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